

AUTHOR VISIT

Meet the Author Jeff Kurrus

20 years of inspiring K-8 readers with stories they never want to put down

"I always have something to write about - and so do you."

While he's here, Jeff will be signing his books for your students.

jeffkurrus.com | [@jeffkurrus](https://twitter.com/jeffkurrus)

PROGRAMS

Zoom Q&A | Grades K-8

Jeff connects with students virtually, answering questions about the writing life and how he tackles the complicated (but thrilling) writing process. Works especially well with reluctant writers.

Writer's Workshop | Grades K-2

Jeff reads the Golden Sower-nominated "Have You Seen Mary?", then introduces his 7 Question Words: Who, What, When, Where, How, Why, and Can. Students start building stories within minutes.

Writer's Workshop | Grades 3-5

Starting with an excerpt from "The Legend of Donnie Bats," Jeff walks students through his 7 Question Words, then layers in drawing, storyboarding, and a technique called "Once Upon a Time" to tackle writing's hardest challenge: getting started.

Author Q&A | Grades K-8

Jeff draws on 20 years of working with student writers to give an authentic, story-driven look at the life of an author.

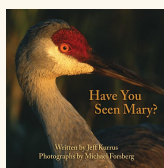
Photography Workshop | Grades 6-8

Jeff shares 20 years of experience as a professional outdoor photographer for the award-winning Nebraskaland Magazine. Students learn the basics of composition, aperture, and shutter speed, plus photography's most important tool: an alarm clock.

WHAT JEFF NEEDS

Not much. A whiteboard helps, but he's hosted plenty of classes outdoors. As long as he has his timer, your students will write - and have fun doing it. For assemblies, a microphone is nice, but his voice can fill an auditorium.

BOOKS AVAILABLE FOR PURCHASE & SIGNING



Have You Seen Mary?

Golden Sower Finalist | Ages 5+

When migration separates two sandhill cranes on the Nebraska prairie, one searches the landscape alone to find her way home.

\$9.95 (paperback) / \$17.00 (hardcover)



The Tale of Jacob Swift

Ages 5+ | Bridges readers into longer stories

Two swift fox brothers face every danger the shortgrass prairie throws at them, and not every story ends the way you expect.

\$17.00 (hardcover)

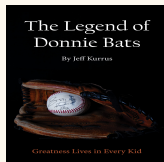


Can You Dance Like John?

Follow-up to Have You Seen Mary? | Ages 5+

John and Mary are back, and this time the story asks a question every reader will carry long after the last page.

\$17.00 (hardcover)



The Legend of Donnie Bats

Chapter Book | Grades 3+ | Perfect for Reluctant Readers

Donnie Bats loves baseball but can't hit, throw, or catch - until he discovers he might just be the best player his town has ever seen.

\$12.95 (paperback)

Bulk school orders available at a reduced rate. Contact Jeff directly to arrange.

WHAT EDUCATORS ARE SAYING

"Jeff Kurrus Days' are a core memory for every student who has had the chance to experience them. We are so lucky to work with him!"

- Mrs. Lisa Giles, 4th Grade, Ashbury Elementary

"Jeff's session was one of the highest-rated at the symposium, even among an outstanding lineup of nationally recognized literacy experts."

- Jeanna, Archdiocese of Omaha

SCHOOL VISIT PRICING

Visit Type	Rate
Standard visit (full day)	\$1,000/day + book sales
Repeat / local schools	\$500/day + book sales
Civic and community groups	No fee (book sales only)

All pricing is negotiable. Reach out and let's talk about what works for your school.

Jeff Kurrus

Children's Book Author | Award-Winning Photographer
Editor, Nebraskaland Magazine
Endorsed by Joel Sartore, National Geographic Photo Ark



Scan to visit
jeffkurrus.com

For Teachers and Librarians

How Jeff's programs align with classroom standards

Curriculum Alignment

Jeff's classroom programs are designed to support, not replace, the work teachers do every day. Each session connects to specific Common Core English Language Arts standards through hands-on writing, structured questioning, and authentic author conversation.

Writer's Workshop, Grades K-2

Reading *Have You Seen Mary?* aloud and building stories with the 7 Question Words supports **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.K-2.3** (narrative writing), **RL.K-2.1** (asking and answering questions about a text), and **SL.K-2.1** (collaborative discussion).

Writer's Workshop, Grades 3-5

Working from an excerpt of *The Legend of Donnie Bats*, Jeff layers questioning, drawing, and storyboarding to scaffold narrative composition. Aligns to **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.3-5.3** (narrative writing with descriptive detail), **W.3-5.5** (planning and revising), and **RL.3-5.1** (referring to text for answers).

Author Q&A and Zoom Q&A, Grades K-8

Live discussion of the writing process supports **SL.K-8.1** (collaborative discussion) and **SL.K-8.3** (asking and answering questions to clarify). Frequently the highest-impact session for reluctant writers.

Photography Workshop, Grades 6-8

Composition, aperture, and shutter speed introduced as a visual storytelling craft. Connects to **CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.SL.6-8.5** (multimedia components in presentations) and supports cross-disciplinary work with science and visual arts.

Support for English Language Learners

Jeff's program design draws on scaffolding strategies that align with the WIDA English Language Development Standards Framework, 2020 Edition. The 7 Question Words approach (Who, What, When, Where, How, Why, Can) is itself a foundational scaffold for emerging multilingual learners, and the workshops use multiple modes of expression so students at different proficiency levels can participate meaningfully.

Key Language Uses engaged across Jeff's programs:

- **Narrate.** Both Writer's Workshops center on building original stories. Drawing and oral storyboarding give multilingual learners non-verbal entry points before written production.
- **Inform.** The 7 Question Words framework is, in practice, the inform structure. Sentence stems built from WH-questions are widely used in WIDA-aligned ELL instruction.
- **Explain.** The Photography Workshop walks students through technical concepts step by step, supporting academic language development around process and cause-and-effect.

Jeff is a children's author, not a credentialed ELL specialist. These alignments describe how his program design supports classroom teachers and ELL co-teachers in their own standards-aligned work.

Companion resource. A standards-aligned **Donnie Bats Activity Pack** with vocabulary work, comprehension questions, and a teacher's standards summary is available as a free download at jeffkurrus.com/school-visits.

BOOK A SCHOOL VISIT

Jeff Kurrus

Children's Book Author | Award-Winning Photographer

Editor, Nebraskaland Magazine

Endorsed by Joel Sartore, National Geographic Photo Ark

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